my name mentioned along with that of the legendary Nelson Mandela, who was also honoured at the same convocation. What could I possible have in common with a legend like Mandela? Perhaps it was our persistence in our missions. My mission of advancing rocketry in my country was perhaps nothing when compared with Mandela's mission of achieving dignity for a great mass of humanity; but there was no difference in the intensity of our passions. "Be more dedicated to making solid achievements than in running after swift but synthetic happiness," was my advice to the young audience.

The Missile Council declared 1991 the Year of Initiative for DRDL and RCI. When we chose the route of concurrent engineering in IGMDP, we selected a rough track. With the completion of developmental trials on Prithvi and Trishul, our choice was on test now. I exhorted my col eagues to commence user trials within the year. I knew that it was going to be a tough task, but that was not going to discourage us.

Rear Admiral Mohan retired and his deputy, Kapoor, was to take over Trishul. I had always admired Mohan's understanding of missile command guidance. This sailor-